

249 Create a desert garden

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Not all gardens grow vegetables and flowers. You can make a pretty desert garden filled with succulents—plants that store water in thick, fleshy leaves and stems. Best of all—they won't prick you like cacti!

What you need

- Trowel • Spoon
- Shallow container
- Gravel • Soil-based potting compost
- Grit • Desert plants



1 Make sure the container has drainage holes in the bottom. Add a thin layer of gravel, then half-fill it with potting compost.

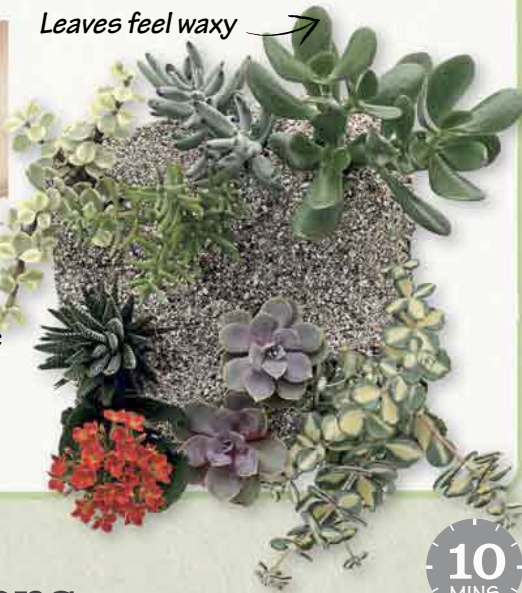


2 Carefully remove the plants from their pots. Plant them, filling in any gaps between the plants with more compost.



3 Lightly water the plants. Spoon the grit on top of the soil. This helps water drain away from the surface and prevents rot. It also gives a "desert look."

Leaves feel waxy →



250 Look for lichens

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Lichens are actually an alga and a fungus that live together in places with no soil. Look for their crusty or stringlike shapes on walls, trees, buildings, and rocks.

